

1 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

How might Teddy feel?

What we are practising

Name possible feelings and consider a kind response.

What you need

No materials; a soft toy is optional

Tell the story about an imaginary animal.

Before you begin

Choose a calm moment; children may pass on any question.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Say: "Teddy built a tower and it fell."
2. Ask how Teddy might feel and accept more than one idea.
3. Try a kind response, such as "Would you like help rebuilding?"

Talk, draw or show your idea

How could we find out what Teddy needs?

Space to explore

2 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The friendly pretend shop

What we are practising

Take conversational turns and make a clear request.

What you need

Three large safe household objects

Draw goods on paper and point to them.

Before you begin

Set out a towel, cup and toy as shop goods; no money is needed.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Model a request: "May I have the cup, please?"
2. Let the shopkeeper hand over the named object and reply.
3. Swap roles, then try asking for an object that is not available.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could the shopkeeper say if there are no cups left?

Space to explore

3 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Fold a little towel

What we are practising

Follow an ordered practical task and check the result.

What you need

Two small clean towels

Use two cloth napkins.

Before you begin

Place a towel flat in front of each person.

Stay with your child and use large, intact, age-appropriate materials.

Try it together

1. Smooth your towel and invite the child to copy.
2. Bring one short edge to the opposite edge and press the fold.
3. Fold once more if manageable, then carry the towels to their shelf together.

Talk, draw or show your idea

What could we adjust if one edge sticks out?

Space to explore

4 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A home for every toy

What we are practising

Use categories and shared roles to complete a household task.

What you need

Two open baskets / Six large toys of two types

Use two clear areas on a low shelf instead of baskets.

Before you begin

Choose a small area; agree that cars go here and soft toys there.

Use light open containers on the floor; an adult handles heavy objects and lids.

Try it together

1. Place one example toy in each basket.
2. Take turns choosing a toy and saying where it belongs.
3. Check the area together and celebrate the shared job without racing.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How will we remember where to find the cars tomorrow?

Space to explore

5 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Our turn-taking tower

What we are practising

Practise shared turns and agree how to restart after a fall.

What you need

Six large lightweight blocks

Use broad lightweight empty boxes.

Before you begin

Sit on the floor with the blocks between you.

Build on the floor using lightweight blocks and keep the tower below the child's shoulder.

Try it together

1. Agree "one block each turn" and place the first block.
2. Take turns adding blocks while naming whose turn comes next.
3. If it falls, pause and agree whether to rebuild or make a wider base.

Talk, draw or show your idea

How can we make room for both our ideas?

Space to explore

6 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Joining the pretend picnic

What we are practising

Practise asking to join and leaving space for a reply.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw three toy guests and act out a joining request.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two toy bears are having a picnic. Your toy wants to join. What could it say or show first?

Space to explore

7 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The borrowed orange crayon

What we are practising

Identify how to return a borrowed item to its owner.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a borrowed crayon going back to its owner.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your pretend rabbit borrowed a crayon and has finished using it. What could it do next?

Space to explore

8 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Listen to the chosen shape

What we are practising

Repeat a request to check which shape was chosen.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Act out checking a toy's drawing request.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A toy asks for a circle, but you are about to draw a square. How could you check what it wanted?

Space to explore

9 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A different game today

What we are practising

State a play preference and suggest an alternative.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Give a character words for choosing a quieter activity.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A friend suggests a loud pretend drum game. Your character wants a quiet game. What could it say?

Space to explore

10 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

One guest has no paper

What we are practising

Notice when someone is missing a needed material.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw the friends and propose a way for all three to take part.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Three pretend friends want to draw, but only two have paper. What could they try together?

Space to explore

11 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Naming a shared drawing

What we are practising

Look for a shared name that includes two people's ideas.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Say two possible titles and invent a shared one.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

One toy calls your shared drawing "The Park" and another calls it "The Trees." How could you choose a title together?

Space to explore

12 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

While the puppet finishes

What we are practising

Choose something useful to do while waiting for a turn.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw two puppets and a waiting plan.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your puppet wants a book that another puppet is still looking at. What could it do while waiting?

Space to explore

13 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

An accidental mark

What we are practising

Acknowledge an accidental mark and ask before changing another person's work.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Act out a response to an accidental drawing mark.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A pretend friend accidentally draws a line on your character's picture. What could they say before trying to fix it?

Space to explore

14 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

The message for the red boat

What we are practising

Pass on a short message while keeping its important detail.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Repeat the boat message and draw where the boats belong.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A toy asks you to tell another toy, "Put the red boat by the blue boat." Which words must you remember?

Space to explore

15 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

A picture to say thank you

What we are practising

Link an expression of thanks to a specific helpful act.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a thank-you picture for one helpful action.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A character helped your toy find its missing hat. What could your toy draw to show what it appreciates?

Space to explore

16 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Enough space for two

What we are practising

Plan enough shared drawing space for two people.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw a page with room for two contributors.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Two characters draw on one sheet. One spreads across the whole page. What arrangement could give both room?

Space to explore

17 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Before moving the tower picture

What we are practising

Ask before moving something another player has arranged.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Act out asking before moving someone's drawing.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

Your character wants to move another character's tower drawing to make room. What should it find out first?

Space to explore

18 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Two kinds of help

What we are practising

Check which kind of help a person actually wants.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Offer a puppet two helpful choices.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A puppet is making a picture and says it wants help. How could you learn which help it means?

Space to explore

19 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Notice the careful attempt

What we are practising

Describe an observed effort with specific encouraging words.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Give a toy specific feedback about an attempt.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A toy tries three times to draw a bridge and finds a shape it likes. What could you say about its work?

Space to explore

20 / 20 | Ages 3-4 | 10 minutes

Which instruction comes first?

What we are practising

Recognise that one simple action can need another action first.

What you need

Paper / Large crayons

Describe or gesture your idea while a partner draws or writes.

Before you begin

Read the question aloud together. Use imagined people and places.

A grown-up reads and joins in; use intact drawing tools and let the child pause or pass.

Try it together

1. Draw or act the two steps for storing a picture.
2. Show or say your first answer before reading the example.
3. Explain one choice, then try the extra challenge if you wish.

Talk, draw or show your idea

A toy needs to put a drawing into a folder, but the folder is closed. What small instruction helps it start?

Space to explore

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

1. How might Teddy feel?

A little hint

Suggest asking rather than assuming: help, a pause, or trying alone?

Answer / what to notice

Teddy might feel sad, annoyed or ready to try again; asking what helps is a useful response.

The same event can bring different feelings, so faces alone do not tell us everything.

Make it easier

Offer two feeling words and allow pointing.

Take it further

Invent two different helpful responses.

Another day, away from the screen

Use “Would you like help?” during ordinary play.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

2. The friendly pretend shop

A little hint

Offer “We do not have that; would you like this instead?”

Answer / what to notice

A clear spoken request, gesture or point is welcome; replies should match what is available.

Waiting for the other person’s reply makes the exchange easier to follow.

Make it easier

Offer only two goods and model both roles.

Take it further

Ask for two goods in one request.

Another day, away from the screen

Practise a clear request during a family snack.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

3. Fold a little towel

A little hint

Line up the corners before pressing the fold.

Answer / what to notice

A usable fold is enough; edges do not need to be perfectly matched.

Breaking a job into a few visible actions helps a child join in.

Make it easier

An adult holds one edge while the child brings the other across.

Take it further

Explain the steps to a toy before folding another towel.

Another day, away from the screen

Choose one small folding job after laundry.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

4. A home for every toy

A little hint

Leave an example visible or draw a simple picture label.

Answer / what to notice

Any agreed, reachable storage arrangement works if everyone can find and return the toys.

A consistent home for objects supports finding them again.

Make it easier

Tidy only three toys into one basket.

Take it further

Let the child propose and explain the two categories.

Another day, away from the screen

Draw a picture label for each basket.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

5. Our turn-taking tower

A little hint

Try choosing the next block together before placing it.

Answer / what to notice

A shared construction with fair turns meets the task; its height is not the goal.

A predictable turn rule helps both builders contribute.

Make it easier

Pass each block directly to the next builder.

Take it further

Agree on two sections to build separately and connect.

Another day, away from the screen

Use the same turn rule when adding to a shared drawing.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

6. Joining the pretend picnic

A little hint

Ask about joining before moving the toys' things.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It could ask, "May I join?" and wait for their reply. Other reasoned ideas can work.

An invitation to respond lets the other players help decide how to include someone.

Make it easier

Repeat a short joining phrase or point to the group.

Take it further

Invent a reply that offers a place or another time.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

7. The borrowed orange crayon

A little hint

Think about where the owner expects the crayon to be.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It can return the crayon and say, "Thank you; I have finished." Other reasoned ideas can work.

Returning a shared item helps its owner find and use it again.

Make it easier

Choose between returning it and keeping it hidden.

Take it further

Ask where to put it if the owner is busy.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

8. Listen to the chosen shape

A little hint

Say back the word you heard.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I could ask, “Did you say a circle?” before drawing. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Repeating a detail checks understanding before an action.

Make it easier

Point to a circle and square for the toy to choose.

Take it further

Check two details: the shape and its size.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

9. A different game today

A little hint

Name what you prefer without calling the other game bad.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "I would like something quiet. Could we draw together?" Other reasoned ideas can work.

A clear preference and another idea can help people find a workable activity.

Make it easier

An adult sketches two quiet activities; choose one.

Take it further

Let the friend suggest another quiet option.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

10. One guest has no paper

A little hint

Who has not had a place to draw yet?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They could share a large sheet if everyone agrees, or ask for another sheet. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Noticing who is missing a resource helps the group make room for participation.

Make it easier

Point to the friend who needs paper.

Take it further

Offer a second solution that does not use extra paper.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

11. Naming a shared drawing

A little hint

Look for a word or idea from each title.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They could combine their ideas as “Trees in the Park” if both like it. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Combining contributions can create a choice that includes both ideas.

Make it easier

Choose between two combined titles offered by an adult.

Take it further

Invent a completely new title and ask both toys about it.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

12. While the puppet finishes

A little hint

Choose something else to do and a way to know the turn is ready.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It could look at another book and agree to be told when this one is free. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A clear next step makes waiting more understandable than an unexplained delay.

Make it easier

Choose a second book for the waiting puppet.

Take it further

Decide what to do if the first puppet wants much longer.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

13. An accidental mark

A little hint

First say what happened; then ask what would help.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "I made that mark by accident. Would you like help changing it?" Other reasoned ideas can work.

Asking before changing someone's work keeps their choice part of the repair.

Make it easier

Complete "Would you like me to...?"

Take it further

Invent a repair that keeps the original mark.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

14. The message for the red boat

A little hint

Which boat moves, and where does it go?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I need the red boat, the blue boat and “beside” so the place is clear. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A short message needs both the object and what should happen to it.

Make it easier

Use just “Put the boat here” with a pointing gesture.

Take it further

Let the listener repeat the message before drawing.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

15. A picture to say thank you

A little hint

Show what the helper actually did.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: It could draw the helper finding the hat and say thank you for looking. Other reasoned ideas can work.

A specific thank-you connects appreciation to an action.

Make it easier

Point to a helpful action in an adult's drawing.

Take it further

Thank a different fictional helper using another detail.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

16. Enough space for two

A little hint

Show where each person can add something.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: They could agree on two areas, or choose parts of one shared scene. Other reasoned ideas can work.

Agreeing on space before adding marks can support both contributions.

Make it easier

Choose a side of a divided page.

Take it further

Make room for a third contributor without hiding anyone's work.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

17. Before moving the tower picture

A little hint

The picture belongs to someone with a preference.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "May I move your picture? Where would you like it?" Other reasoned ideas can work.

Checking permission can prevent an unwanted change to another person's work.

Make it easier

Use a simple yes-or-no permission question.

Take it further

Find another way to make space if the answer is no.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

18. Two kinds of help

A little hint

Offer two small kinds of help and listen.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: I could ask, “Should I hold the paper or help choose a colour?” Other reasoned ideas can work.

Different forms of help leave different decisions with the person asking.

Make it easier

Ask about one kind of help at a time.

Take it further

Accept “I will try alone first” as another choice.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

19. Notice the careful attempt

A little hint

Mention what changed between the attempts.

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "You tried another shape and found one that works for your picture." Other reasoned ideas can work.

Describing an observed action makes feedback clear and useful.

Make it easier

Name one thing the toy tried.

Take it further

Ask the toy which attempt it liked and why.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.

For the grown-up

Use these prompts when useful. Open-ended activities can have many good answers. Let your child explain their thinking.

20. Which instruction comes first?

A little hint

What is stopping the picture from going inside?

Answer / what to notice

Example answer: "Open the folder first, then place the picture inside." Other reasoned ideas can work.

Some actions depend on an earlier action being finished.

Make it easier

An adult sketches an open and a closed folder; point to the one ready for the drawing.

Take it further

Add a final step that helps find the drawing later.

Another day, away from the screen

Swap the fictional roles and test whether your response still works for everyone involved.